FAMILY DEVOTIONS FOR THE WEEK

Faith Formation for Families • The Congregation at Prayer • Week of September 6–12, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Invocation
In the name of the Father and of the ✠ Son and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

Introit (see back page)

Memory Verse for the Week — Jude 24–25

"Now to Him who is able to keep you from stumbling and to present you blameless before the presence of His glory with great joy, to the only God, our Savior, through Jesus Christ our Lord, be glory, majesty, dominion, and authority, before all time and now and forever. Amen."

Daily Readings: LSB p. 299

Sun: 2 Kings 4:8–22, 32–37; Ephesians 5:15–33
Mon: 2 Kings 4:38—5:8; Ephesians 6:1–24
Tue: 2 Kings 5:9–27; Philippians 1:1–20
Wed: 2 Kings 6:1–23; Philippians 1:21—2:11
Thu: 2 Kings 9:1–13; 10:18–29; Philippians 2:12–30
Fri: 2 Chronicles 29:1–24; Philippians 3:1–21
Sat: 2 Chronicles 31:1–21; Philippians 4:1–23

Talk About It This Week

Each day, read the appointed readings (or just one), then ask: *Where did we hear God's Word planted today? What is God teaching us to trust?* Day-by-day questions for younger and older children are in the daily devotion pages (and on the web page).

In Our Prayers This Week (LSB Daily Prayer Themes)

✠ **Sun:** the joy of the resurrection; fruit of faith in all who heard the Word today
✠ **Mon:** our Baptism, callings, and daily work; schools; good government and peace
✠ **Tues:** deliverance from temptation and evil; the addicted and despairing
✠ **Wed:** marriage and family; parents and children; our home and community
✠ **Thurs:** the Church, pastors, teachers, and missionaries; thanksgiving for the Sacrament
✠ **Fri:** the preaching of the cross; the persecuted; the sick and the dying
✠ **Sat:** faithfulness to the end; hearts made ready for the Lord's Day

Hymn of the Week: "Lord Jesus Christ, Be Present Now" — LSB 902

Lord Jesus Christ, be present now; / Our hearts in true devotion bow. / Your Spirit send with grace divine, / And let Your truth within us shine.

Apostles' Creed

Lord's Prayer

Benediction

Let us bless the Lord. **Thanks be to God.**

HOW TO USE THIS PAGE… Gather once a day — at breakfast, supper, or bedtime. Speak the Invocation, say the memory verse together, read the day's readings, talk about them, sing the hymn stanza, pray for the day's theme, and close with the Lord's Prayer and Benediction. Ten minutes is plenty. The seed does the work — "so shall My word be… it shall not return to Me empty" (Isaiah 55:11).

The Fifteenth Sunday after Pentecost (Proper 18) September 6, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Introit *Psalm 92:1–4; antiphon: v. 5*

How great are your works, O LORD!
Your thoughts are very deep!
It is good to give thanks to the LORD,
to sing praises to your name, O Most High;
to declare your steadfast love in the morning,
and your faithfulness by night,
to the music of the lute and the harp,
to the melody of the lyre.
For you, O LORD, have made me glad by your work;
at the works of your hands I sing for joy.
Glory be to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit;
as it was in the beginning, is now, and will be forever. Amen.
How great are your works, O LORD!
Your thoughts are very deep!

Collect of the Day

O God, from whom all good proceeds, grant to us, Your humble servants, Your holy inspiration, that we may set our minds on the things that are right and, by Your merciful guiding, accomplish them; through Jesus Christ, Your Son, our Lord, who lives and reigns with You and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever. Amen.

This Sunday's Readings

Ezekiel 33:7–9 · Psalm 32:1–7 · Romans 13:1–10 · Matthew 18:1–20

Gradual *Psalm 34:9, 19*

Oh, fear the LORD, you his saints,
for those who fear him have no lack!
Many are the afflictions of the righteous,
but the LORD delivers him out of them all.

Next Sunday's Readings (Proper 19)

Genesis 50:15–21 · Psalm 103:1–12 · Romans 14:1–12 · Matthew 18:21–35

Learn by Heart: Holy Baptism — What benefits does Baptism give? *LSB p. 325*

"It works forgiveness of sins, rescues from death and the devil, and gives eternal salvation to all who believe this, as the words and promises of God declare."

THIS WEEK AT HOME: The disciples ask who is greatest, and Jesus answers by putting a child in front of them. Then He tells of a shepherd who leaves ninety-nine sheep to go find one that wandered off, because it is not the Father's will that one of these little ones should perish. This week Elisha's story is full of small, overlooked people whom God notices: a grieving mother, a foreign soldier with a skin disease, a servant girl, a man who lost a borrowed axe head. Ask one another: "Who is the person our family is most likely to overlook — and what would going after them look like?"

Kids in the Divine Service — What is the "church"?

When someone says "church," we usually think of a building people go to. But the Lutheran Confessions teach that the church is the assembly of all believers among whom the Gospel is preached in its purity and the holy Sacraments are administered according to the Gospel. The church is so much more than a building!

So why does the building matter? Because it is a place where God has promised to come to us in His Word and Sacraments. This week Jesus says, "Where two or three are gathered in My name, there am I among them" — the smallest gathering of His people, and He is there.

Parents: *Point out the Gospel-rich symbols in your sanctuary — the altar, the windows, the banners. Remind your children that the Lord truly comes to us here and brings what we most need: the forgiveness of sins.*

Scripture quotations are from the ESV® Bible, © 2001 by Crossway. Introit, Collect, and Gradual from Lutheran Service Book, © 2006 Concordia Publishing House. "KIDS in the Divine Service" © 2017 LCMS Worship, created by Christopher Thoma; LCMS congregations have permission to reproduce for their use.